

YVES SHABO NKULU-ILY

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LEARNING DESIGN & EDUCATIONAL TECHNOLOGY | XR/AI & HAPTICS | MEDICAL EDUCATION

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Learning design and educational technology researcher-practitioner with 18+ years of experience across higher education, e-learning, technical training, ICT support, proposal development, and international development. Ph.D. Candidate in Education at the University of Kentucky, specializing in Learning Design & Technology. Published research examines XR/AI, haptics, feedback, and simulation-based learning in medical education.

SELECTED IMPACT

- Co-designed and implemented the ESIS higher-education computing initiative and supported the training of 1,000+ IT technicians.
- Recognized by the University of Kentucky Intellectual Property Committee as the disclosed originator of Invention Report 2541, an internet-based immersive 3-D orthopedic learning environment using augmented reality (December 2020).
- Published research in Interactive Learning Environments, the European Journal of Open, Distance and E-Learning, and Springer's Lecture Notes in Computer Science.
- Designed IT network infrastructure and trained two dozen staff at SOCODAM; trained 15 staff at Catholic Relief Services.
- Developed proposal materials for public health, education, new media, technical workshops, and research initiatives.

EDUCATION

University of Kentucky | Lexington, KY **Aug 2017–Present**

Ph.D. Candidate in Education, Teaching and Learning / Learning Design & Technology

- Graduate Certificate, Distance Education, May 2020
- Graduate Certificate, Research Methods in Education, May 2019

Institute of Statistics of Lubumbashi | Lubumbashi, Democratic Republic of the Congo **Sep 1995–Oct 2000**

Licentiate Degree in Statistics, computing focus

Sitec Training College Ltd | United Kingdom **Jan 2004–Jun 2004**

OCR Certificate for IT Practitioners, Level II; Cisco Networking Academy IT Essentials I embedded

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

University of Kentucky | Lexington, KY **Aug 2017–May 2021**

Teaching Assistant

Supported EDC 317, Introduction to Instructional Media, a 1-credit course for Semester 6 pre-service teachers preparing to teach diverse P-12 learners.

Guided selection, production, and integration of analog and digital media with instructional goals, applying UDL and multimedia design principles to reduce cognitive load.

Supported multimedia production using video-editing, presentation, image-manipulation, and learning-management tools; coached 2- to 3.5-minute digital media concepts.

Independent / Freelance | Lubumbashi, Democratic Republic of the Congo / Remote **Feb 2009–Present**

Proposal Writer

- Coordinate proposal-development support for public health, education, new media, technical workshop, and research initiatives.
- Monitor requests for proposals, identify relevant opportunities, and distribute opportunities to appropriate contributors.
- Coordinate writing inputs and deadlines across multiple proposal efforts.

Catholic Relief Services | Lubumbashi, Democratic Republic of the Congo **Aug 2008–Feb 2009**

MIT

- Supported network infrastructure, troubleshooting, backups, archiving, and disaster-recovery activities.
- Identified system requirements and analyzed business rules and process needs to inform system improvements.
- Trained 15 staff using e-learning and team-based learning methods.

SOCODAM s.p.r.l. | Lubumbashi, Democratic Republic of the Congo **Jan 2007–Jul 2008**

IT Manager

- Designed the company's IT network infrastructure and trained two dozen staff.
- Led IT training and program-improvement activities while supporting departmental operations and financial administration.
- Reorganized filing systems to improve office efficiency and customer service.

Computer Consultant

- Contributed technical expertise to consulting engagements and developed an application supporting computerized delivery of information, advice, and guidance.

Institute of Salama / ESIS Project | Lubumbashi, Democratic Republic of the Congo

Jan 2001–Oct 2002

Project Designer

- Helped shape and implement the initial plan for a French Cooperation-funded higher-education computing initiative.
- Selected learning materials and technology-enabled methods to strengthen the instructional environment.
- Represented ESIS in partnership discussions and helped secure partner participation.
- Designed and developed the ESIS website with online applications for new students.

PUBLICATIONS

- Nkulu-Ily, Y. S., Gantwerker, E. A., Vaughan, N., Cheng, Q., & Dhanda, J. (2026). Simulating realistic surgeon decisions and actions in immersive medical distance education with XR and AI. *Interactive Learning Environments*, 34(4), 2223–2268. DOI: 10.1080/10494820.2025.2542893.
- Nkulu-Ily, Y. S. (2023). Implementation of e-learning curriculum in higher education. *European Journal of Open, Distance and E-Learning*, 25(1), 62–73. DOI: 10.2478/eurodl-2023-0005.
- Nkulu-Ily, Y. S. (2023, May). Combining XR and AI for integrating the best pedagogical approach to providing feedback in surgical medical distance education. In *International Conference on Intelligent Tutoring Systems* (pp. 452–466). Springer Nature Switzerland. DOI: 10.1007/978-3-031-32883-1_41.

LEADERSHIP & COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

NGO AKILIMALI | Lubumbashi, Democratic Republic of the Congo

Jul 2003–Present

Co-Founder / Volunteer Supervisor

- Supervise team members supporting community-based programs and contribute to organizational development planning and grant proposals.

SKILLS

Learning Design; Instructional Design; Educational Technology; E-Learning; Distance Education; XR/AI and Haptics; Medical Education; Simulation-Based Learning; Research Methods; Technical Training; Proposal and Grant Writing; Microsoft Windows; Microsoft Office Suite; Network Support; Software Installation; Technical Troubleshooting; Backups; Archiving; Disaster Recovery; Knowledge of Programming; Cross-Functional Collaboration; Partnership Development; Writing and Editing.

Languages: English (fluent/bilingual); French (native/bilingual); Swahili (conversational).